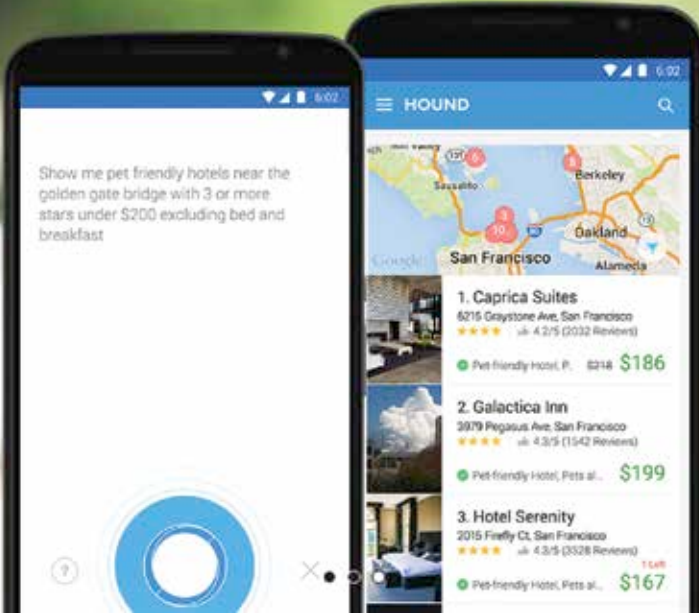




The Hound app looks to compete with Google Now by supporting more complex voice commands

tant. Similarly, we have Apple's and Microsoft's equivalent with Siri and Cortana, respectively, both of which have taken a page (more like a sheaf) out of Google's playbook.

In the context of wearables, a voice-based interface is such an obvious choice. What better way to communicate with a device that has no screen and is placed close enough that you can talk to it? Well, you talk to it. In fact, Google Glass and Microsoft HoloLens both support voice commands. Furthermore, almost all flagship Android Wear devices support voice input with Google Now integration. Now, making a note to pay the bills is as easy as literally telling your watch "make a note to pay the bills." What a time to be alive.

Voice-based interfaces are essential for the continued development on the concept of the Internet of Things. Soon, homes will be referred to as smart homes that run on smart energy, use smart appliances and are controlled via smart devices. It is only natural that the most preferred method of interaction is that which is most intuitive, i.e. voice. It is only a matter of